

SHAILESH RAVAL



Keeping His Promises

AHMEDABAD Few would contest that Narendra Modi is cast in a different mould. Having proved pollsters and political pundits wrong by winning hands down in the assembly elections last month, the Gujarat chief minister is now on to his next task.

After enabling Gujarat post a 10.6 per cent growth rate against a target of 10.2 per cent in the recently ended Tenth Five Year Plan, Modi has declared that his Government's next agenda is to

improve the state's human development index and bring it on par with that of developed nations. It's a challenging task considering that India ranks 128th on the index and Gujarat ranks sixth in India.

"Unless fruits of development reach the lowest in society, development has little meaning. I am confident we shall achieve this target too as we have done in many areas in the past," says Modi.

To put his agenda into effect, Modi has given the

MILES TO GO: Modi health portfolio to Jaynarayan Vyas, former Narmada development minister of Gujarat, who is known for his efficiency. The chief minister has made it clear that inefficiency does not bode well in his administration by dropping seven ministers of his earlier cabinet mostly for 'incompetency'.

On the other hand, the chief minister has rewarded his ministers who have lived up to his expectations. Roads and buildings portfolio has gone to his confidante Anandiben Patel, while Amit Shah retains home and has also been given law and judiciary. Saurabh Patel continues as energy and finance minister. But a questioning finger has been raised on Raman Vora's appointment as education minister—he is not particularly known for his efficiency.

Modi is sending out a clear signal that he is intent on delivering on what he has promised. However, he may have taken upon himself a rather daunting task.

by Uday Mahurkar

SIGNPOSTS

AWARDED: To Ramanathan Krishnan, the Asian Sports Journalists' Federation's Lifetime Achievement Award for 2006. He won the Wimbledon Junior title in 1954 and was a semi-finalist twice.

DIED: Orthopaedic surgeon and inventor of the fa-



mous Jaipur foot, **Dr P. K. Sethi**, 80, who developed the artificial limb in 1968. He

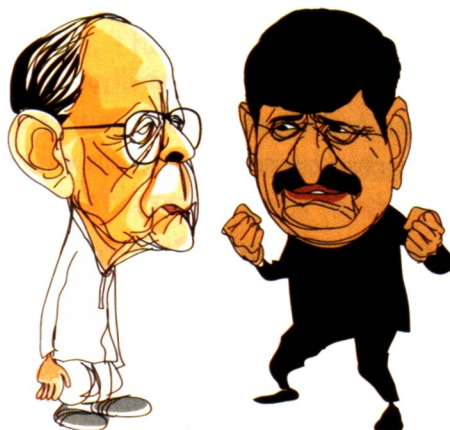
figured in the *Guinness Book of World Records* for the record number of people using the 'foot'.

ELECTED: Lok Sabha Speaker **Somnath Chatterjee**, as the chairperson of the Conference of Speakers and Presiding Officers of the Commonwealth for two years.

DIED: **S.K. Agrawal**, 55, director-projects, Nuclear Power Corporation of India Limited. He was responsible for the construction of all the Indian nuclear reactors and those about to come up.

VIS-A-VIS **JYOTI BASU** CPI(M) leader **versus** **RAVISHANKAR PRASAD** BJP spokesperson

Socialism is still a far cry. We are working within the capitalist system and private capital has to be used for industrialisation.



SAURABH SINGH

The metamorphosis of a Marxist like Basu to a supporter of capitalism reiterates that Marxists have never understood India.

EPILOGUE: Marxists not having understood India doesn't mean capitalists have done so.